

**Honorable Erwin Tanner-Tiziani**

**Secretary of the Commission for the Dialogue with Muslims of the Swiss Bishops' Conference**

Dear Sir,

With best wishes and greetings to you and your esteemed colleagues, it is to inform you that we have received a copy of your email sent to the Embassy of the Islamic Republic of Iran in Bern on May 16, and thank you very much.

Unfortunately, the global outbreak of the coronavirus has led to unwanted delays in the dialogues between this center and the Swiss Bishops' Conference. Based on the previous proposal made by that esteemed conference, we were looking forward to the sixth round of our dialogues to be held from 21 to 25 June 2022. However, after receiving an e-mail from your side we came to know that due to certain changes in the members of the Islamic Committee of the conference, you consider it unavoidable to postpone the program to the second half of this year or the first half of 2023.

In this regard, I would like to inform you that certain changes have also taken place here in the last few months and following the end of Dr. Abuzar Ebrahimi's term as the president of our organization Hojjat al-Islam Dr. Mahdi Imanipour is now the President of the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization and the Council for Policy-Making and Coordination of Interfaith Dialogue.

Also, with the retirement of Dr. Mehdi Tashkhiri, I have now taken over as the Head of this center. Fortunately, however, there is no change in the speakers of the Iranian delegation.

Although we prefer the next round of talks to be held this year, we will, however, wait to receive the exact date proposed by the Swiss Bishops' Conference, which is hosting the sixth round of talks between the two sides, whether this year or next year, and we will respond subsequently.

Please convey our warm greetings to His Excellency Alain de Raimi; Inform the person in charge of the interfaith dialogue of the Swiss Bishops' Conference, as well as the esteemed members of the Islamic group of this conference.

I pray to God Almighty for the health and success of dear friends.

**Sincerely,**

**Aliakbar Ziaei**

**Head of the Center for Interreligious and Intercultural Dialogue**